

Chapter 14 — Life and the Economy

What this chapter covers

어휘	Vocabulary 경제 관련 어휘 — prices, jobs, exchange rates, the business cycle
문법	Grammar 동형-으므로 / 명은/는커녕 — since, therefore · let alone
활동	Activities 경제 상황에 대해 말하기, 물가에 대한 기사문 쓰기 — discussing the economy; writing a news piece about prices
문화와 정보	Culture and information 국민연금 — the National Pension

This is the most formal chapter in the book. Both grammar points belong to written and public Korean rather than conversation: -으므로 is the 'therefore' of news bulletins and reports, and the whole chapter is built around a news broadcast, a survey article and a graph.

The cover photograph is a television news bulletin with the caption 김장철 배춧값 폭등 — cabbage prices spiking in kimchi-making season. That is a real annual news story in Korea, and it is the thread the speaking page picks up on page 185.

The culture page is worth reading even if the grammar defeats you. 국민연금 is compulsory for foreign residents with an income, it is deducted from your payslip, and the page tells you when you can be exempt.

Getting started

What the source page shows

환전소의 환율 전광판

an exchange counter, the board listing rates for USD, JPY, CNY, HKD, THB, TWD, GBP, CAD, CHF

채용 공고 게시판

a crowd reading job notices on a recruitment bulletin board

이 사람들은 지금 여기에서 무엇을 보고 있어요?

What are these people looking at?

여러분은 생활 속에서 경제의 중요성을 느낀 적이 있어요?

Have you ever felt the importance of the economy in your own life?

환전 is changing money and 환율 is the exchange rate — both built on 환, exchange. The rate board gives won per unit of foreign currency, so 1135.00 beside 미국 USD means one dollar costs 1,135 won. A rising number means the won is weaker.

The two photographs are the chapter in miniature: a rate board and a job board. Prices and employment are the two things this chapter gives you the language to talk about, and they are the two that most affect an immigrant's life directly.

Vocabulary

1. 경제 상황이 어떤 것 같아요? 이야기해 보세요.

1. How does the economy look to you? Talk about it.

물가 — prices, from the onion and cabbage figures

물가가 상승하다

for prices to rise — 양파 1kg: 지난주 1,800원 → 이번 주 3,000원, up 66%

물가가 하락하다

for prices to fall — 배추 1포기: 지난주 3,400원 → 이번 주 2,700원, down 21%

실업률 — from the youth unemployment chart

실업률이 감소하다

for the unemployment rate to fall — 2012 8.0 → 2013 7.4

실업률이 증가하다

for it to rise — 2017 9.2 → 2018 10.5

경기 — the business cycle

경기가 호황이다

for business to be booming

경기가 불황이다

for business to be in a slump

환율 — from the won-dollar chart

환율이 내리다

for the exchange rate to go down — 2월 1087.8 → 3월 1063.5

환율이 오르다

for it to go up — 5월 1077.7 → 6월 1097.7

2. 다음의 현상들은 경제에 어떤 영향을 줄까요?

2. What effect would each of these have on the economy?

개인 소비 증가

a rise in personal spending

원재료 가격 인상

a rise in raw material prices

환율 변동

movement in the exchange rate

부동산 가격 급등

a sharp jump in property prices

수요 증가

rising demand — 수요 ↑ 가격 ↑

공급 증가

rising supply — 공급 ↑ 가격 ↓

일자리 감소

a fall in the number of jobs

경기 침체

an economic downturn

물가는 the general price level, not the price of one thing. One item's price is 가격 or 값. So 물가가 올랐어요 means the cost of living has gone up, while 배춧값이 올랐어요 is about cabbage. The chapter's writing task asks for 물가, so the distinction matters.

Korean has a precise ladder for price movement. 상승/하락 are neutral and statistical. 인상/인하 are deliberate — somebody raised or lowered the price. 급등/급락 are sharp and sudden. 폭등/폭락, which you meet on page 188, are violent. The chapter uses all of them, and choosing the right rung is what the writing task is really testing.

경기 here is the business cycle, not 경기 meaning a sports match — same spelling, different word. 호황 and 불황 are its two states, and 침체는 a downturn or stagnation. 경기가 침체되다 and 경기 침체 are both common.

수요 and 공급 — demand and supply — behave exactly as the little diagrams show: demand up pushes price up,

supply up pushes price down. These two words unlock most economic writing in Korean, and they recur in the reading.

Grammar 1 — 동형-으로

앞 내용에 대한 근거나 이유를 나타낼 때 사용한다. 주로 뉴스, 회의, 발표 등 공식적인 상황에 어울린다.
Used to give the grounds or reason for what precedes. It suits formal settings — news, meetings, presentations.

아나운서 올해 청년 취업률에 대해서 어떻게 생각하십니까?

What is your view on youth employment this year?

전문가 올해 채용 기회가 늘어나므로 취업률도 높아질 것으로 예상됩니다.

Since hiring opportunities are increasing this year, the employment rate is expected to rise as well.

예문 — Examples

가 예정된 시간이 되었으므로 바로 회의를 시작하겠습니다.

As the appointed time has come, we shall begin the meeting at once.

나 네, 그럼 제가 먼저 보고를 드려도 될까요?

Yes — may I give my report first, then?

낮과 밤의 기온 차가 크므로 건강에 유의해야 한다.

As the gap between day and night temperatures is large, you should take care of your health.

요즘 경기가 호황이므로 서민 경제도 좋아지고 있다.

Since business is booming at present, ordinary people's finances are improving too.

Forms

읽다 → 읽으므로

-으므로 after a consonant

높다 → 높으므로

adjectives behave the same

오르다 → 오르므로

-므로 after a vowel or ㄹ

내리다 → 내리므로

-므로 after a vowel

호황이다 → 호황이므로

nouns take 이므로

Tip from the book: 명사는 '명이므로'를 사용한다 — with a noun, use 이므로.

Do not confuse -으므로 with -음으로. They sound identical but -음으로 is the noun form 음 plus the particle 으로, meaning 'by means of': 책을 읽음으로써 지식을 얻는다, one gains knowledge by reading. If the sentence means 'because', it is -으므로 with no ㅁ on the stem.

Against -어서 and -으니까, this is the formal register. -어서 is neutral, -으니까 is conversational and often introduces a suggestion, and -으므로 belongs to writing and public speech. You would not say it to a friend, but you will hear it in every news broadcast and read it in every official notice.

Because it is formal, it pairs with formal endings. Notice 예상됩니다, 유의해야 한다, 좋아지고 있다 — the 합니다 style or the plain written style, never 해요. Matching the ending to the connective is part of using it correctly.

연습 1 — 보기와 같이 올바른 것끼리 연결하고 문장을 완성해 보세요

오늘은 미세먼지 농도가 높으므로 외출을 자제하시기 바랍니다.

As fine dust levels are high today, please refrain from going out.

보기) 오늘은 미세먼지 농도가 높다 → 외출을 자제하다

high fine dust levels → refraining from going out

1) 최근 물가가 많이 올랐다 → 음식 가격 인상을 이해해 주다

prices have risen lately → understanding a rise in food prices

2) 눈 때문에 길이 미끄럽다 → 운전 속도를 줄이다

snow has made the road slippery → reducing your speed

3) 내일 중요한 회의가 있다 → 반드시 참석하다

there is an important meeting tomorrow → attending without fail

4) 다른 관객에게 방해가 되다 → 휴대 전화 전원을 끄다

it disturbs other members of the audience → switching your phone off

2. 다음 문제에 대한 여러분의 의견을 친구들 앞에서 발표해 보세요.

2. Present your opinion on these issues to your classmates.

인터넷 실명제 — 찬성 / 반대

real-name internet registration — for or against

청소년의 연애 — 찬성 / 반대

teenage dating — for or against

취업 준비생의 다이어트와 성형 — 찬성 / 반대

dieting and cosmetic surgery by job seekers — for or against

저는 인터넷 실명제에 찬성합니다. 인터넷 실명제는 누가 쓴 글인지 숨길 수 없으므로 악플이 줄어들 것입니다.

I am in favour of real-name registration. Since it makes it impossible to hide who wrote a post, malicious comments will decrease.

표현의 자유가 없어지므로 저는 인터넷 실명제에 반대합니다.

Since it removes freedom of expression, I am against real-name registration.

This exercise is the point of the grammar: 찬성합니다 and 반대합니다 with -으므로 carrying the reason is exactly how an opinion is stated formally in Korean. Learn the frame — 저는 ...에 찬성합니다/반대합니다. ...으므로 ... — and you can argue any of the three topics.

단어장 — New words**농도**

concentration, density

자제하다

to refrain, to hold back

실명제

a real-name system

숨기다

to hide, to conceal

Grammar 2 — 명은/는커녕

앞의 내용은 물론이고 그것보다 못한 것도 부정할 때 사용한다.

Used to deny not only what comes first but even something lesser than it.

애나 현금을 많이 가지고 다니는 편이에요?

Do you tend to carry a lot of cash?

제이슨 아니요, 카드를 사용하니까 현금은커녕 지갑도 안 가지고 다녀요.

No — I use cards, so never mind cash, I don't even carry a wallet.

예문 — Examples

가 회사에서 보너스 좀 받았어요?

Did you get a bonus at work?

나 아니요, 보너스는커녕 아직 월급도 안 받았어요.

No — forget a bonus, I haven't even been paid yet.

과제 제출은커녕 아직 시작도 못 했다.

Never mind handing the assignment in, I haven't even started.

요즘에는 극장에서 영화는커녕 집에서 텔레비전 볼 시간도 없다.

These days, let alone a film at the cinema, I haven't even time for television at home.

Forms

칭찬 → 칭찬은커녕

은커녕 after a consonant

선물 → 선물은커녕

은커녕 after a consonant

고기 → 고기는커녕

는커녕 after a vowel

투자 → 투자는커녕

는커녕 after a vowel

The structure is fixed and worth memorising whole: A은/는커녕 B도 + negative. A is the thing you might have hoped for, B is something far more modest, and the sentence denies both. The 도 on B is not optional — it carries the 'even'.

So the order is always from bigger to smaller. 보너스는커녕 월급도 means bonus first, then the humbler salary. Reversing them makes no sense in Korean, exactly as 'let alone' cannot be reversed in English.

It is emphatic and slightly complaining in tone, so it belongs to speech and informal writing, not to the formal register of -으므로 on the previous page. The two grammar points of this chapter sit at opposite ends of the scale, which is useful: you now have one form for a report and one for a grumble.

English has several matches — 'let alone', 'never mind', 'far from'. Korean also has 은/는커녕 as a standalone retort: 커녕요, hardly. Do not try to translate it word by word; recognise the shape and reach for whichever English idiom fits.

연습 1 — 보기와 같이 친구와 이야기해 보세요

가 요즘 취업이 잘돼요?

Is it going well, finding work these days?

나 아니요. 취업은커녕 아르바이트도 구하기 어려워요.

No — never mind a proper job, even part-time work is hard to find.

기대하는 상황 → 기대에 못 미치는 상황

보기) 요즘 취업이 잘되다 → 아르바이트 구하기도 어렵다

work going well → even part-time work hard to find

1) 매일 한국어 숙제를 하다 → 복습할 시간도 없다

doing Korean homework daily → no time even to revise

2) 꾸준히 저축하고 있다 → 생활비도 부족한 상황이다

saving steadily → not even enough for living costs

3) 아침에 밥 먹고 출근했다 → 늦게 일어나서 물도 못 마셨다

ate breakfast before work → got up late, didn't even drink water

4) 된장찌개를 끓일 수 있다 → 라면도 못 끓이다

can make doenjang stew → can't even make instant noodles

2. 여러분의 생각대로 되지 않는 상황에 대해서 친구와 같이 이야기해 보세요.

2. Talk with a partner about situations that did not go as you expected.

해외여행, 국내 여행

a trip abroad, a trip at home

취업, 학교 졸업

getting a job, graduating

취미 생활, 잠 잘 시간

time for a hobby, time to sleep

날씨가 좋아지면 가족과 해외여행을 가려고 했어요. 그런데 갑자기 바빠져서 해외여행은커녕 국내 여행도 못 갈 것 같아요.

I meant to take the family abroad once the weather improved. But things suddenly got busy, so never mind going abroad, I don't think we'll manage a trip at home either.

Speaking

1. 라민 씨와 아나이스 씨가 물가와 경제에 대해 이야기합니다. 다음 대화처럼 이야기해 보세요.

1. Ramin and Anais are talking about prices and the economy. Practise a conversation like this one.

라민 아나이스 씨, 오늘 뉴스 보니까 요즘 김장철이라 배추 가격이 급등했대요.

Anais, I saw on the news today that cabbage prices have jumped because it's kimchi season.

아나이스 아, 그래요? 저는 몇 달 전에 태풍 때문에 배춧값이 떨어졌다는 기사를 봤어요. 그때하고 상황이 많이 달라졌네요.

Oh really? A few months ago I read an article saying cabbage prices had fallen because of a typhoon. Things have changed a lot since then.

라민 그렇게 말이에요. 물가에 영향을 미치는 요인이 다양하니까요.

Quite. There are so many different factors that affect prices.

아나이스 맞아요. 그리고 보니 라민 씨는 경제에 관심이 많은 것 같아요.

True. Now I think of it, you seem very interested in the economy.

라민 네, 학교에서 친구들과 취업 준비 동아리를 하면서 경제 문제에 대해 자주 이야기하거든요. 경기가 좋아야 취업이 잘되니까 늘 신경을 쓰고 있어요.

Yes — I'm in a job-hunting club at school with friends and we often discuss the economy. Jobs only come when business is good, so I keep an eye on it.

아나이스 와, 멋진 태도예요. 저도 앞으로 경제에 더 관심을 가져야겠어요.

That's a good attitude. I should pay more attention to the economy myself.

Swap in these pairs

1) 김장철이라 배추 가격이 급등하다 / 태풍 때문에 배춧값이 떨어지다

cabbage prices jumping in kimchi season / falling because of a typhoon

2) 휴가철이라 항공료 가격이 많이 오르다 / 비수기에 항공료 반값 할인을 하다

air fares rising in the holiday season / half-price fares in the off season

김장 is the autumn making of a winter's worth of kimchi, and 김장철 is the season for it, roughly November. Demand for cabbage spikes in a few weeks, so the price does too — the textbook's example is the most ordinary economics story in Korea.

영향을 미치다, to exert an influence, is the set phrase; 요인 is a factor or cause. 물가에 영향을 미치는 요인 — the factors affecting prices — is exactly the phrase you want for the writing task on page 189.

경기가 좋아야 취업이 잘되니까 uses the -어야 of chapter 14 in level 3: jobs come only when business is good. 신경을 쓰다 is to pay attention or worry about something, literally to use one's nerves.

2. 다음의 경제 상황과 그 영향에 대해 이야기해 보세요. 그리고 여러분의 생각도 이야기해 보세요.

2. Talk about these economic situations and their effects, and give your own view.

경제 상황 — the situation

경기가 호황이다

business is booming

공급이 급증하다

supply rises sharply

원재료 가격이 급등하다

raw material prices jump

영향 — the effect

구직이 잘되다 / 어렵다

job hunting goes well / is hard

물가가 상승하다 / 하락하다

prices rise / fall

실업률이 증가하다 / 감소하다

unemployment rises / falls

단어장 — New words

김장철

kimchi-making season

요인

a factor

비수기

the off season

Listening

1. 여러분은 면접 때 어떤 옷을 입습니까? 옷차림이 경제 상황과 관계가 있다고 생각합니까?

1. What do you wear to an interview? Do you think dress has anything to do with the economy?

정장을 입고 면접을 보는 사람

a woman in a dark suit before a panel of interviewers

자유로운 옷차림의 면접

a relaxed office, an applicant in casual clothes

2. 라디오 방송에서 기자가 이야기합니다. 잘 듣고 질문에 답해 보세요.

2. A reporter is speaking on the radio. Listen carefully and answer the questions.

1) 무엇에 대한 이야기인지 고르세요.

1) Choose what the talk is about.

① 불황일수록 단정한 옷차림이 취업에 유리하다.

The worse the slump, the more neat dress helps in getting hired.

② 불황일수록 화려한 옷차림이 취업에 유리하다.

The worse the slump, the more showy dress helps.

③ 호황일수록 보수적인 옷차림이 취업에 유리하다.

The better the boom, the more conservative dress helps.

2) 들은 내용과 같으면 ○, 다르면 X 하세요.

2) Mark ○ if it matches what you heard, X if not.

① 경기 침체기에는 보수적인 사람들이 채용을 담당한다.

In a downturn, conservative people handle the hiring.

② 단정한 옷차림은 신뢰감을 준다.

Neat dress inspires trust.

③ 경제 상황과 면접 옷차림은 관계가 없다.

The economy has nothing to do with interview dress.

3) 들은 내용은 누구에게 가장 도움이 됩니까?

3) Who would find this most useful?

① 면접관

the interviewer

② 경제 전문가

an economist

③ 취업 준비생

someone preparing to job hunt

-을수록 means 'the more ... the more'. 불황일수록 is 'the deeper the slump, the more...'. It often appears doubled with 면 — 불황이면 불황일수록 — for emphasis. Worth recognising here even though it is not this chapter's grammar.

The three 단어장 adjectives describe dress and are a neat set: 단정하다 neat and tidy, 자유분방하다 free and unconstrained, 보수적 conservative. 신뢰감 is a feeling of trust — 감 makes a feeling noun, as in 고립감 in chapter 13.

튀다 literally means to bounce or splash, but of a person it means to stand out conspicuously — and usually not as a compliment. In an interview context, 튀는 옷차림 is dress that draws the wrong kind of attention.

발음 — Pronunciation

받침 + [이, 야, 여, 요, 유] → 받침 + [니, 냐, 녀, 뇨, 뉴] (ㄴ 첨가)

Between a final consonant and a following i- or y- sound, an ㄴ is inserted.

환+울 [환눌]

ㄴ inserted after 환

다음을 듣고 따라 읽으세요.

Listen and repeat.

지난주보다 환율이 떨어졌다.

The exchange rate has fallen since last week.

환전하는 곳에 따라 환전율이 다르다.

The rate differs depending on where you change money.

국민연금에 가입하는 것은 의무이다.

Joining the National Pension is compulsory.

환전+율 [환전눌]

ㄴ inserted after 전

국민+연금 [국민년금]

ㄴ inserted, and 국 assimilates to [궁]

This is ㄴ 첨가, ㄴ-insertion, and it happens at the seam of a compound word. 환 and 율 are separate elements, so an ㄴ appears between them: [환눌], not [화눌]. A single word with no seam does not do this.

국민연금 shows two rules at once. The ㄴ is inserted before 연, and then the new ㄴ turns the preceding ㄱ into [ㅇ] by nasal assimilation, giving [국민년금]. This is why the word sounds so unlike its spelling, and why it is drilled on the same page as the culture reading about it.

The same rule explains 꽃잎 [곤닙], 한여름 [한녀름] and 색연필 [생년필]. If a word suddenly grows an ㄴ you did not write, look for the compound seam.

단어장 — New words**옷차림**

dress, what one is wearing

유리하다

to be advantageous

단정하다

to be neat and tidy

자유분방하다

to be free-spirited, unconstrained

보수적

conservative

신뢰감

a sense of trust

적절하다

to be appropriate

튀다

to stand out conspicuously

Reading 1

1. 다음은 내년 경제 상황 전망에 대한 그래프입니다. 어떤 내용인지, 여러분의 의견은 어떤지 이야기해 보세요.

1. Here is a graph of expectations for next year's economy. Say what it shows and give your own view.

내년 경제 상황 전망 — the pie chart

매우 좋아질 것이다 — 20%

it will get much better

약간 좋아질 것이다 — 15%

it will get slightly better

지금과 비슷할 것이다 — 30%

it will be much as it is now

약간 나빠질 것이다 — 20%

it will get slightly worse

매우 나빠질 것이다 — 15%

it will get much worse

그렇게 전망하는 이유 — reasons given

▲ 물가 안정

stable prices

▲ 고용 안정

stable employment

▲ 취업률 증가

a rising employment rate

▲ 부동산 가격 안정

stable property prices

▼ 물가 불안정

unstable prices

▼ 취업률 감소

a falling employment rate

▼ 의료비 인상

rising medical costs

▼ 교육비 부담

the burden of education costs

전망 is an outlook or forecast — literally a distant view. 전망하다 is to forecast, and 그렇게 전망하는 이유 is 'the reasons for forecasting so'. It is the standard word above any chart of expectations.

Read the chart carefully before answering: 35% expect improvement, 35% expect deterioration, and the largest single block, 30%, expects no change. The optimists and pessimists cancel out exactly, which is the interesting thing to say about it.

안정 (stability) against 불안정 (instability) runs down both halves of the reasons box, and it is the word the article on page 188 turns on. 고용 is employment as a state; 취업 is getting hired. Both appear here.

Reading 2

2. 다음의 신문 기사는 무엇에 대한 것입니까? 이야기해 보세요.

2. What is each of these newspaper articles about? Talk about them.

쌀값 잡아라!! 물가 안정 위해 정부가 긴급 수매

Rein in the rice price! Government buys up stocks urgently to steady prices

항공료, 비수기에 가면 최대 35% 싸다

Air fares up to 35% cheaper if you travel off season

청년 일자리 지원 사업 확대

Youth employment support scheme expanded

'자녀 교육비 부담 줄여 드립니다' 새 학기부터 학생 교복비 지원

'We'll ease the cost of your children's education': school uniform subsidy from the new term

잡다 is to catch or seize, but with a price it means to bring under control — 물가를 잡다, to rein prices in. The headline's 잡아라 is the plain imperative, which headlines use for urgency.

수매 is government purchase of a crop to support or steady its price, and 긴급 means urgent. These four headlines are the four policy levers a government has: buy up supply, seasonal pricing, job schemes, and

subsidies.

Reading 3 — 새해에 가장 듣고 싶은 뉴스, 1위는 물가 안정

3. 다음은 신문 기사입니다. 잘 읽고 질문에 답해 보세요.

3. The following is a newspaper article. Read it carefully and answer the questions.

OO신문 | 20XX. 6. 13.

OO Daily, 13 June 20XX

본문 — The article

H경제리서치에서 남녀 직장인 1,000명을 대상으로 새해에 가장 듣고 싶은 뉴스가 무엇인가에 대한 설문 조사를 실시했다. 그 결과, '물가 안정'이라고 답한 응답자가 전체의 31%로 가장 높게 나타났다. 이어서, 새해에 가장 듣고 싶은 뉴스 2위는 '취업률 증가' 또는 '일자리 증가'(23%)인 것으로 나타났다.

H Economic Research surveyed 1,000 working men and women on the news they would most like to hear in the new year. 'Stable prices' came first, given by 31% of respondents. Second, at 23%, was 'a higher employment rate' or 'more jobs'.

이러한 결과는 전체 응답자의 절반 이상이 물가 안정과 고용 안정을 가장 바라고 있음을 보여 준다. 또 물가 급등과 청년 실업률 증가에 대한 최근의 경제 상황이 영향을 미친 결과로 분석된다.

The finding shows that more than half of all respondents want stable prices and stable employment above all. It is read as reflecting the recent economic picture of sharply rising prices and rising youth unemployment.

이외에도 설문 응답자의 15%가 '부동산 가격 안정'을 듣고 싶은 새해 뉴스로 꼽았다. 그 뒤를 이어 '의료비 지원 확대(12%)', '교육비 지원 확대(10%)', 기타(9%) 등의 순으로 다양한 응답이 나왔다.

Beyond these, 15% named 'stable property prices'. Then followed 'wider medical support' at 12%, 'wider education support' at 10%, and others at 9%.

OO신문 | 000 기자

OO Daily, by 000

질문 — Questions

1) 다음 중 응답자들이 가장 바라는 것의 사례로 맞는 것을 고르세요.

1) Choose the example that matches what respondents most want.

① 대기업에서 올해 직원을 더 채용하려고 한다.

A large firm plans to hire more staff this year.

② 삼겹살 가격이 지난달에 폭락했다가 이번 달에 폭등했다.

Pork belly crashed last month and spiked this month.

③ 취업 준비생을 위한 지원이 확대되어야 한다.

Support for job seekers should be widened.

④ 작년과 올해의 식비, 교통비가 거의 비슷한 것 같다.

Food and transport costs seem much the same as last year.

2) 윗글의 내용과 같으면 ○, 다르면 X 하세요.

2) Mark ○ if it matches the article, X if not.

① 물가 안정을 바라는 남녀 직장인이 가장 많다.

The largest group of workers want stable prices.

② 응답자는 교육비 지원이 가장 필요하다고 생각한다.

Respondents think education support is needed most.

③ 집값 안정에 대한 응답이 세 번째로 많았다.

Stable house prices was the third most common answer.

3) 설문 결과는 최근의 어떤 경제 상황의 영향을 받은 것입니까? 그 두 가지를 글에서 찾아 쓰세요.

3) Which two recent economic conditions influenced the survey result? Find them in the text.

Question 1 asks for an example of the thing most wanted, which the article says is 물가 안정 — stable prices.

Option ④, food and transport costs being much the same as last year, is precisely what stable prices look like in daily life. ① and ③ are about jobs, which came second, and ② describes the opposite of stability.

Question 3 is answered in the second paragraph: 물가 급등 and 청년 실업률 증가. Note that the article uses 집값 in the question but 부동산 가격 in the text — the exercise is checking you can match a colloquial word to a formal one.

Survey Korean has a fixed vocabulary worth taking whole. 설문 조사를 실시하다 to conduct a survey, 응답자 respondent, 대상으로 with ... as subjects, 나타나다 to be found, 꼽다 to pick out, 그 뒤를 이어 followed by. With these you can read any polling article.

폭락 and 폭등 in option ② are the violent end of the price ladder from page 182 — a crash and a spike. Putting both in one sentence about pork belly is the writer's way of showing instability at its sharpest.

단어장 — New words

폭락

a crash, a plunge in price

폭등

a spike, a surge in price

Writing

1. 우리 생활에서 물가 변화가 크다고 느낀 품목이 있습니까? 그 이유는 무엇인지 메모해 보세요.

1. Are there goods whose prices you have felt change sharply? Note down why.

메모 — three boxes to fill in

물가가 많이 상승한 것 (상승하는 것)

things that have risen a lot in price

물가가 많이 하락한 것 (하락하는 것)

things that have fallen a lot in price

물가 변화 이유

the reason for the change

2. 다음은 항공료 비교 표입니다. 다음 표를 보고 짧은 글을 써 보세요.

2. Here is a table comparing air fares. Write a short piece based on it.

성수기와 비수기의 항공료 비교

J 항공

J Air

성수기 인상율 〈6~8월〉 7% · 비수기 인하율 〈1~2월〉 -25%

M 항공

M Air

성수기 인상율 〈7~8월〉 5% · 비수기 인하율 〈1~2월〉 -15%

P 항공

P Air

성수기 인상율 〈6~8월〉 8% · 비수기 인하율 〈1~2월〉 -35%

성수기 is the peak season and 비수기 the off season — the pair you met on page 185. 인상율 is the rate of increase, 인하율 the rate of reduction. Note that 인상/인하 are deliberate changes made by the airline, which is exactly right here.

The table rewards comparison rather than listing. P Air raises fares most in peak season but also cuts them most off season, a 43-point spread; M Air moves least either way. Saying which airline is most volatile is a better piece of writing than reciting six numbers.

Use the chapter's grammar. -으므로 is made for this: 성수기에는 수요가 증가하므로 항공료가 인상된다. And the task is a 기사문, a news piece, so write in the plain written style — 인상된다, 나타났다, 분석된다 — copying the article on page 188.

A workable shape: one sentence saying what the table shows, two or three comparing the airlines with figures, and a closing sentence on what it means for a traveller. That is the same structure as the survey article, scaled down.

Culture and information — 국민연금

본문 — The text

국민연금은 한국의 대표적인 사회 보장 제도의 하나이다. 국민연금은 소득이 있을 때 매달 보험료를 납부하고 나이가 들거나 장애 등으로 소득이 중단되었을 때 급여를 받는 제도이다. 한국에서는 60세 미만으로서 소득이 있는 사람은 의무적으로 국민연금에 가입해야 한다. 한국에 거주하고 있는 외국인도 한국인과 동등하게 국민연금에 가입해야 한다.

The National Pension is one of Korea's principal social security schemes. Under it you pay a monthly contribution while you have an income, and receive a benefit when that income stops through age or disability. In Korea anyone under 60 with an income must join. Foreign residents must join on the same terms as Koreans.

외국인의 국민연금 가입은 '사업장 가입자'와 '외국인 지역 가입자'로 구분된다. 만 18세 이상 60세 미만의 외국인이 국민연금에 가입된 사업장에 근무하면 사업장 가입자가 된다. 그 외의 외국인은 지역 가입자가 된다. 가입 대상에서 제외되는 경우도 있기 때문에 반드시 확인을 해야 한다. 만약 한국과 사회 보장 협정을 맺은 나라에서 한국으로 파견된 근로자가 자기 나라에서 국민연금에 가입한 증명서를 제출하면 한국에서 국민연금에 가입하지 않아도 된다.

For foreigners, membership divides into 'workplace member' and 'foreign regional member'. A foreigner aged 18 or over and under 60 who works at an enrolled workplace becomes a workplace member; other foreigners become regional members. Some people are excluded, so you must check. A worker posted to Korea from a country that has a social security agreement with Korea need not join here if they submit proof of pension membership in their own country.

이외에도 국가별로 가입 대상인지 아닌지, 체류 자격에 따라 한국의 국민연금 가입 대상인지 아닌지에 대해서는 국민연금공단 홈페이지에서 확인할 수 있다.

Whether you are covered, by nationality and by visa status, can be checked on the National Pension Service website.

질문 — Questions

1) 외국인이 가입하는 사업장 가입자와 지역 가입자는 무엇이 다른니까?

1) What is the difference between a workplace member and a regional member?

2) 자신이 한국의 국민연금 가입 대상인지 알고 싶으면 어느 홈페이지에 들어가면 됩니까?

2) Which website do you visit to find out whether you are covered?

3) 한국의 국민연금 제도에 대해 여러분이 더 알고 싶은 정보는 무엇입니까?

3) What else would you like to know about the scheme?

This is the practical heart of the chapter. If you work for a Korean company you are a 사업장 가입자 and the contribution is split with your employer and taken from your pay — that is the 국민연금 144,180 line on the payslip photograph on the next page. If you are self-employed or otherwise not at an enrolled workplace you are a 지역 가입자 and pay the whole amount yourself.

The sentence about 사회 보장 협정 matters if you were posted here by a foreign employer. Korea has totalisation agreements with many countries, and with the right certificate you keep paying at home instead of here. Ask your employer for it rather than assuming.

체류 자격 is visa status, and it governs coverage — which is why the text sends you to the website rather than giving a rule. The address is www.nps.or.kr and it has an English page.

Two nouns to separate: 보험료 is the contribution you pay in, 급여 is the benefit you receive. 납부하다 is to pay in (formal, used of taxes and contributions), and 가입하다 is to join a scheme — the same verb you met for websites in level 3.

60세 미만으로서 uses 로서, the 'in the capacity of' particle from chapter 13. Here it links two conditions: being under 60 and having an income. Official Korean uses 로서 constantly for defining who a rule applies to.

배운 어휘 확인 — Vocabulary check**물가**

the price level, cost of living

하락하다

to fall

증가하다

to increase

경기

the business cycle, economic conditions

불황

a slump

오르다

to go up

소비

consumption, spending

인상

a rise (deliberate)

부동산

property, real estate

수요

demand

침체

stagnation, downturn

자제하다

to refrain

숨기다

to hide

요인

a factor

옷차림

dress, attire

단정하다

to be neat and tidy

보수적

conservative

적절하다

to be appropriate

폭락

a crash in price

상승하다

to rise

실업률

the unemployment rate

감소하다

to decrease

호황

a boom

환율

the exchange rate

내리다

to go down

원재료

raw materials

변동

fluctuation, movement

급등

a sharp jump

공급

supply

농도

concentration, density

실명제

a real-name system

김장철

kimchi-making season

비수기

the off season

유리하다

to be advantageous

자유분방하다

to be free-spirited

신뢰감

a sense of trust

튀다

to stand out conspicuously

폭등

a spike in price

Sort this list into pairs and it halves. 상승/하락, 증가/감소, 호황/불황, 오르다/내리다, 수요/공급, 폭락/폭등 are six opposed pairs, and 급등 and 침체 attach to that same family. Learning them as opposites is far quicker than

learning them one by one.

The rest divides into the interview vocabulary from the listening page — 옷차림, 단정하다, 보수적, 신뢰감, 튀다 — and a few strays from the grammar exercises. Note that 인상 here is a price rise; the identical-sounding 인상 meaning 'impression' is a different word.